Racial Equity and Social Justice Student Support Service Strategy

Overview and Update



PORTLAND
Public Schools

Board of Education

September 2026

Learning Target and Success Criteria

I am learning about the PPS racial equity student support services strategy.

I can articulate the theory of action PPS uses to support students of color through culturally specific partnerships, the amount of investment made in those partnerships, and the most recent student outcomes based on those partnerships.

Theory of Action

IF... We braid Racial Equity and Social Justice strategies into our instructional core, work with our students, teachers, and content, and build our organizational culture and capacity to create a strong foundation to support every student

...THEN We will reImagine Portland Public Schools to ensure every student, especially our Black and Native American students, realize the vision of the Graduate Portrait.



Five Student Support Strategies

Strategy	Description	
Culturally Specific Family Engagement	Family engagement is designed to reduce or eliminate institutional barriers for families of color to advocate for the needs of their students.	PK-5
Wraparound Services	Provision of culturally specific and culturally responsive services to support student academic and social success. This includes case management, academic tutoring/support, service referral, student groups, and progress monitoring. Wraparound services have a comprehensive approach to meeting the needs of students.	Grade 8 + High School
Leadership Development & Mentoring	Services are designed to provide positive relationship development and support to students to reduce disproportionate discipline rates and increase attendance and a sense of belonging at school for students of color. This includes providing positive and diverse adult relationships that are reflective of students' culture and identity.	Middle School + Grade 9
Extended Learning & Enrichment	Programming provides safe, structured and engaging activities to enhance and expand the learning of students outside of school hours. This includes after school programming and enrichment activities. Enrichment activities provide opportunities for students to pursue learning in their own areas of interest and strengths. Research has shown that students engaged in these activities can lead to increased academic performance and attendance.	Middle School
Positive Cultural Identity Development & Student Advocacy	Programming provides participating youth with exposure and opportunity to engage in activities that empower them to embrace a confident and positive cultural identity while preserving and sharing cultural heritages and traditions amongst their peers. Activities provide opportunities for students to learn and practice new methods of self-expression in a safe and culturally affirming environment.	Middle School

Partnership Scope and Magnitude

23 Culturally Specific Partner Organizations



52 PPS Schools



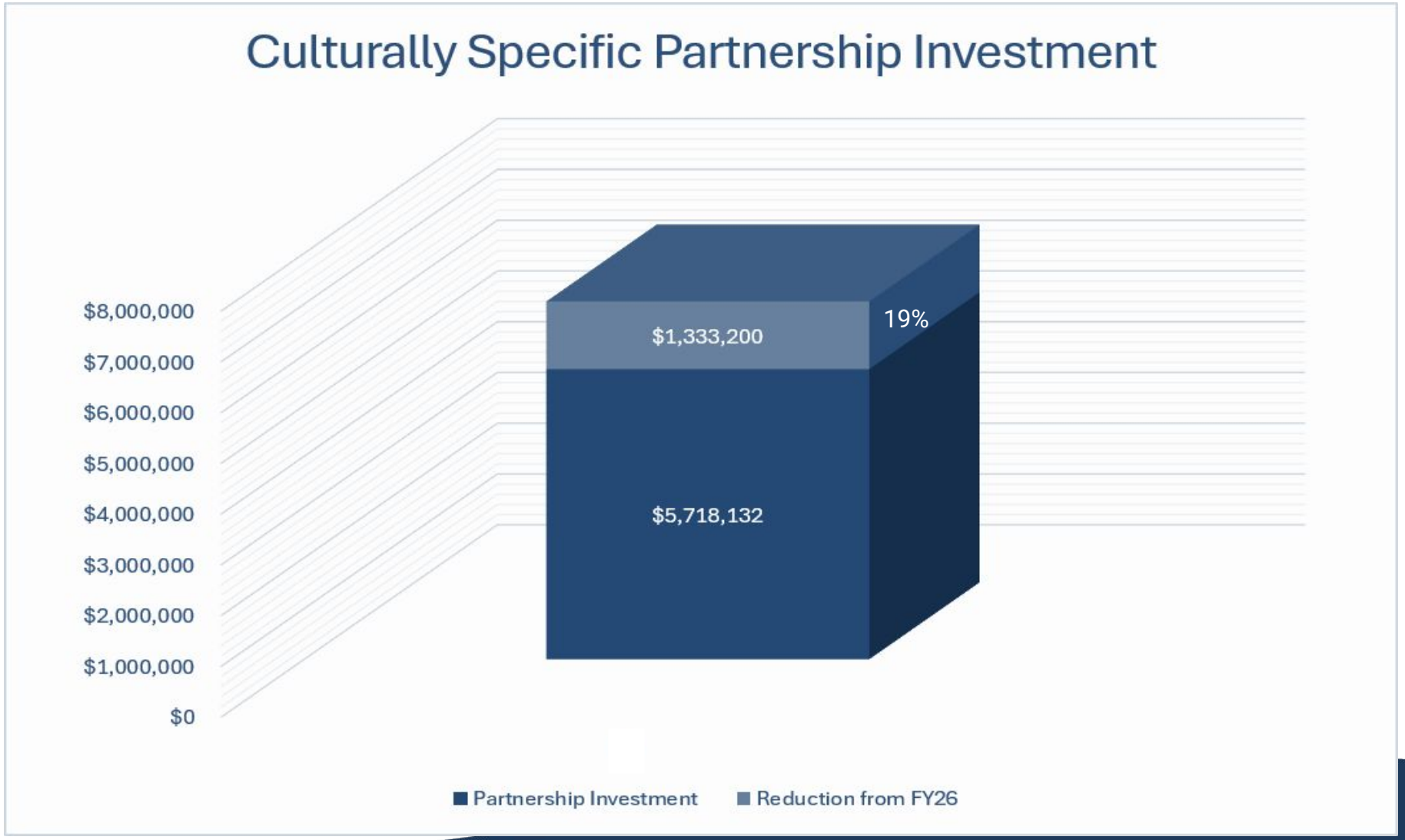
3,415 Students/Families Served and Supported



Over 133,000 Hours of Direct Service



Racial Equity and Social Justice Support Strategy Investment



Partnership investment is supported through the Student Investment Account grant and not General Fund Dollars.

Previous RESJ Services Evaluation Framework

Service Provision
(students/families and hours)

Quarterly Reports by Partners

Building Leader Feedback

Partner Impact
(attendance, reading, math, behavior, graduation)

Revised RESJ Services Evaluation Framework

Service Provision
(students/families and hours)



Quarterly Reports by Partners



Building Leader Feedback



Partner Impact
(attendance, ~~reading, math, behavior, graduation~~)



Partner Impact

Family Survey

- Barriers to engagement
- Self-advocacy
- Increased event participation

Student Survey

- Sense of belonging
- Engagement at school
- Connection with a trusted adult



Notable Outcomes for 2025-26



Attendance improvements were noted across a majority of students and across all partners.

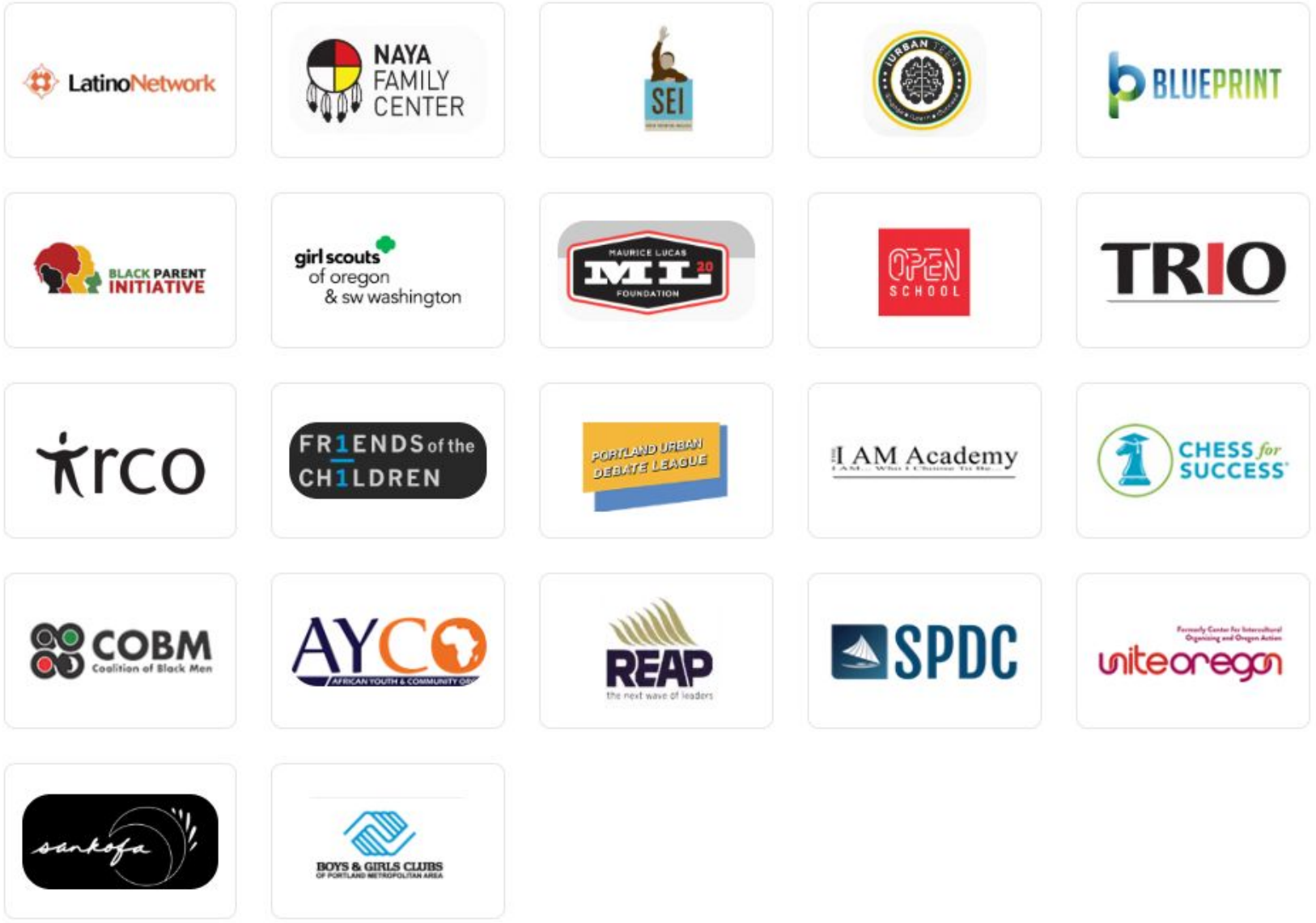


Disciplinary referrals also increased across students being supported by partners.



On-track for graduation indicators showed improvement for students being supported.

Thank You Partners and Principals



Questions and Discussion

